

Incentives for Make in India

- Allocation of ₹ 7.45 billion for MSIPS and Electronic Development Fund to make India a global electronics manufacturing hub
- Defence budget increased by about 5.8 per cent to ₹ 2740 billion with provision for strategic electronics

- No change in excise and service tax rates due to upcoming GST
- Tax relief to startups for seven years
Overall tax reliefs given to startups and MSMEs will boost sustainable employment and the quality of startups in the design-led manufacturing sector.

Encouraging Digital India

- A mission to be set up with a target of ₹ 25 billion digital transactions for 2017-18 through UPI, USSD, Aadhaar Pay, IMPS and debit cards
- Aadhaar based payment system to help people not having debit/credit cards
- Allocation of ₹ 100 billion for BharatNet project for providing high-speed broadband Internet in FY18
- Under BharatNet, OFC laid in 155,000 kilometres
- By the end of 2017-18, high-speed broadband connectivity on optical fibre to be available in more than 150,000 *gram panchayats*, with Wi-Fi hotspots and access to digital services at low tariffs
- DigiGaon initiative to be launched to provide tele-medicine, education and skills through digital technology
- Rural and semi-urban areas to get more funds for creating a digital economy

Facilitating cashless economy

- Aadhaar based payment system to help people not having debit/credit cards
- Rural and semi-urban areas to get more funds for creating a digital economy
- Banks to introduce additional one million point-of-sale machines by March 2017 and two million Aadhaar based swipe machines by 2020

Enabling Skill India

- SANKALP programme for skill development with allocation of ₹ 40 billion
- Proposal to leverage ICT with the launch of *Swayam* platform that has 350 free courses
- Innovation fund for secondary education to be set up
- Prime Minister's *Kaushal Kendras* to be extended to 600 districts; 100 international skill centres to be opened to help people get jobs abroad **EFY**

This report is compiled from information provided by ELCINA Electronic Industries Association of India, by Sudeshna Das, senior executive editor, EFY



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